

The New Face of Parliament

JUNE 1, 2009

Younger, richer and with more women members than ever before, the profile of the Lower House is a reflection of the new India and offers hope that the forum could be an effective agency for positive change.



“Let's hope that this 'T20 brigade' will produce a definite result within a short time, contrary to their 'tested predecessors' who failed to give any even after remaining on the turf for five 'days'.”

RAJNEESH BATRA, via www.indiatoday.in

Young and Famous

The defining attribute of many of the young MPs seems to be their kinship with senior leaders, rather than their age ("The New Surge", June 1). Political leaders rising to power for reasons of ancestry, without much experience of work at the grassroots level, is not the best of auguries for a vibrant democracy. Even so, one hopes that these young MPs will perform their duties better than their predecessors and dispel the misgivings of doubting Thomases.

M.H. RAO, Hyderabad

It is true that the new Parliament will have the largest number of young MPs in 25 years. If one critically examines the credentials of these MPs, however, it may be con-



A New Beginning

After Prabhakaran's death, India must play its diplomatic cards in a manner that the rights of the Tamil population in the island nation are protected through necessary consultation with and monitoring of the Sri Lanka Government ("The End", June 1).

SUBHASH CHANDRA AGARWAL, via www.indiatoday.in

With the war-torn nation's economy being stretched to the fullest, winning the war is only half the battle won for Rajapakse. It is undoubtedly going to be a daunting task for him to rebuild the nation by accommodating the aspirations of both the majority Sinhala and the minority Tamil communities of Sri Lanka.

NALINI VIJAYARAGHAVAN, Thiruvananthapuram

cluded that most of the them are related to political bigwigs as part of a dynastic political power base. In a true democracy one would like to see young faces from the grassroots without the crutches provided by their parents and uncles.

J.N. MAHANTY, Puri

Hunger Strike

It is regretful that over Rs 58,000 crore worth of food perishes annually in India due to lack of proper rules and storage facilities ("Hungry for Action", June 1). An appropriate policy should be framed to raise proper infrastructure in the country by making banks advance loans for these purposes on a priority basis. This colossal loss must be curbed at the earliest.

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